FAST TALK · VULCA SEMINAR 2026 · CUENCA

The power of non-formal education in the maker movement

Sentir Europa, and an invitation to the 1st Iberian FabLab Meeting

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WHY THIS TALK

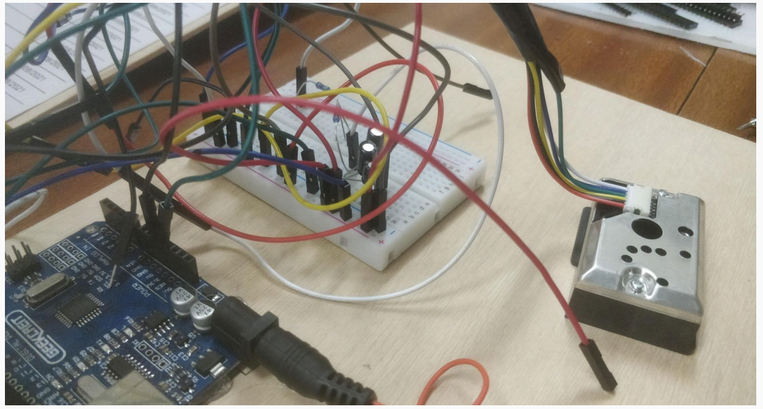
Most people learn to make outside school

- Learning by doing, with peers, without grades
- A real problem from your own street, not an exercise
- Young people with fewer opportunities come in through making
- Fablabs already do it, often alone and without a name for it

HOW WE GOT HERE

One method, tested again and again

2020–21	**Youth Sensing** youth exchange · young people build their own sensors
2021	**Gota d'Água** water, sensors, LoRa · we meet FabLab Mérida
2024	**Castro Verde and Almendralejo** Mérida educators train with us · a youth exchange
2026–27	**Sentir Europa** we coordinate, with FabLab Mérida





SENTIR EUROPA · ERASMUS+ YOUTH · 2026–27

Young rural people measure where they live

70

young people, 15–19, in Alentejo and Extremadura

10

DIY weather stations in their villages

10

youth workers from Portugal and Spain

3

open starter kits, CC BY-SA

Small-scale partnership (KA210-YOU) · Buinho with FabLab Mérida · September 2026 – October 2027

THE METHOD

Twelve sessions, from a question to a proposal

SESSIONS 1–3

Ask

Is my house warm enough? Thermal comfort, sensors, what to measure

SESSIONS 4–8

Build

An Arduino weather station with a temperature and humidity sensor

SESSIONS 9–12

Measure and show

4–8 weeks of data, a thermal map, proposals to the town hall

Groups of about seven, two hours a session, in their own village.

FROM DATA TO VOICE

Is a remote village colder than the town? Young people measure it, and take it to the town hall.

Data turns an abstract climate topic into a local inequality they can act on.



MADE TO BE COPIED

Three starter kits, free for any lab

KIT 1

Thermal comfort

Build a station, measure a home, map a village

KIT 2

Off-grid mesh networks

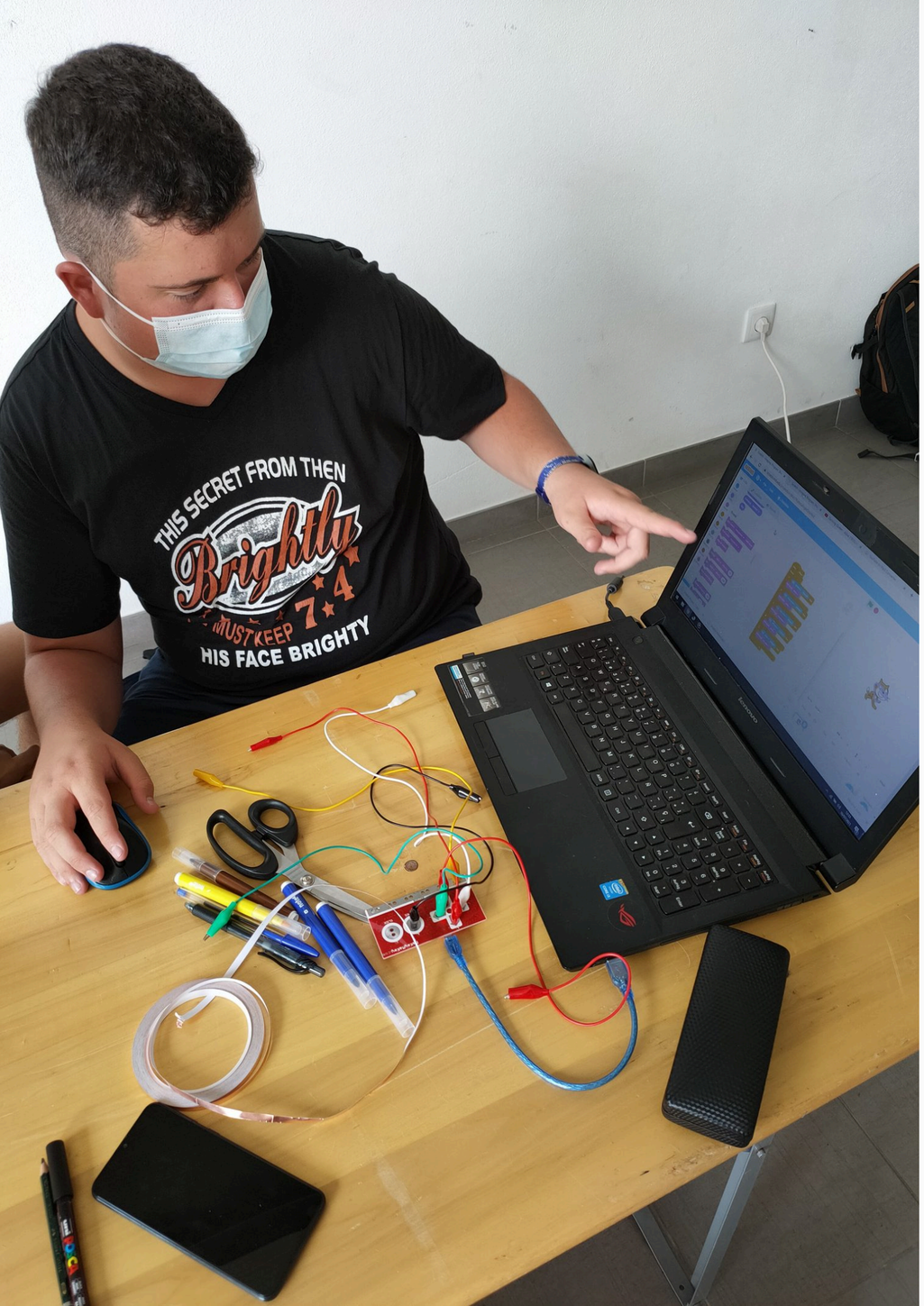
LoRa and Meshtastic, led by FabLab Mérida

KIT 3

Introduction to citizen sensing

For youth workers starting from zero

Videos, templates and guides · Creative Commons BY-SA · on the project website and the Erasmus+ Results Platform



THE INVITATION

1st Iberian FabLab Meeting

- Aljustrel, Alentejo · summer 2027 (dates to confirm)
- Two days, about 30 makers
- Right after the youth exchange: the young people show their work
- For labs that work with young people outside school, or want to

WHAT WE WANT TO DO THERE

Name it, share it, fund it

Name it

What non-formal education looks like in our labs, and why it works

Share it

Hands-on with the kits; your own methods, not only ours

Fund it

Erasmus+ Youth and the Solidarity Corps today, and what changes after 2027

A first step towards an Iberian network of labs doing youth work.

See you in Aljustrel?

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Buinho Creative Hub · Messejana
with FabLab Mérida